

JOURNEY · VERTICAL BOARD · PORTRAIT ·

2026-06-19

The journey, read top to bottom.

A journey is horizontal by nature — stages left to right, mood dipping below a timeline. On a tall deck that strands it in a band. Portrait gets a board of its own: stages stack, each task is a row, and mood reads twice — the row's color and the face's position.

Mood, twice over.

The landscape board is three parallel column-grids; you can't make a stage label group its task *rows* in CSS. So portrait emits a different shape — and encodes mood redundantly so it survives a glance.

Row wash →

Mood, twice over.

Row wash — pain warm, delight cool. The emotional arc is the first thing you see.

Mood, twice over. (cont.)

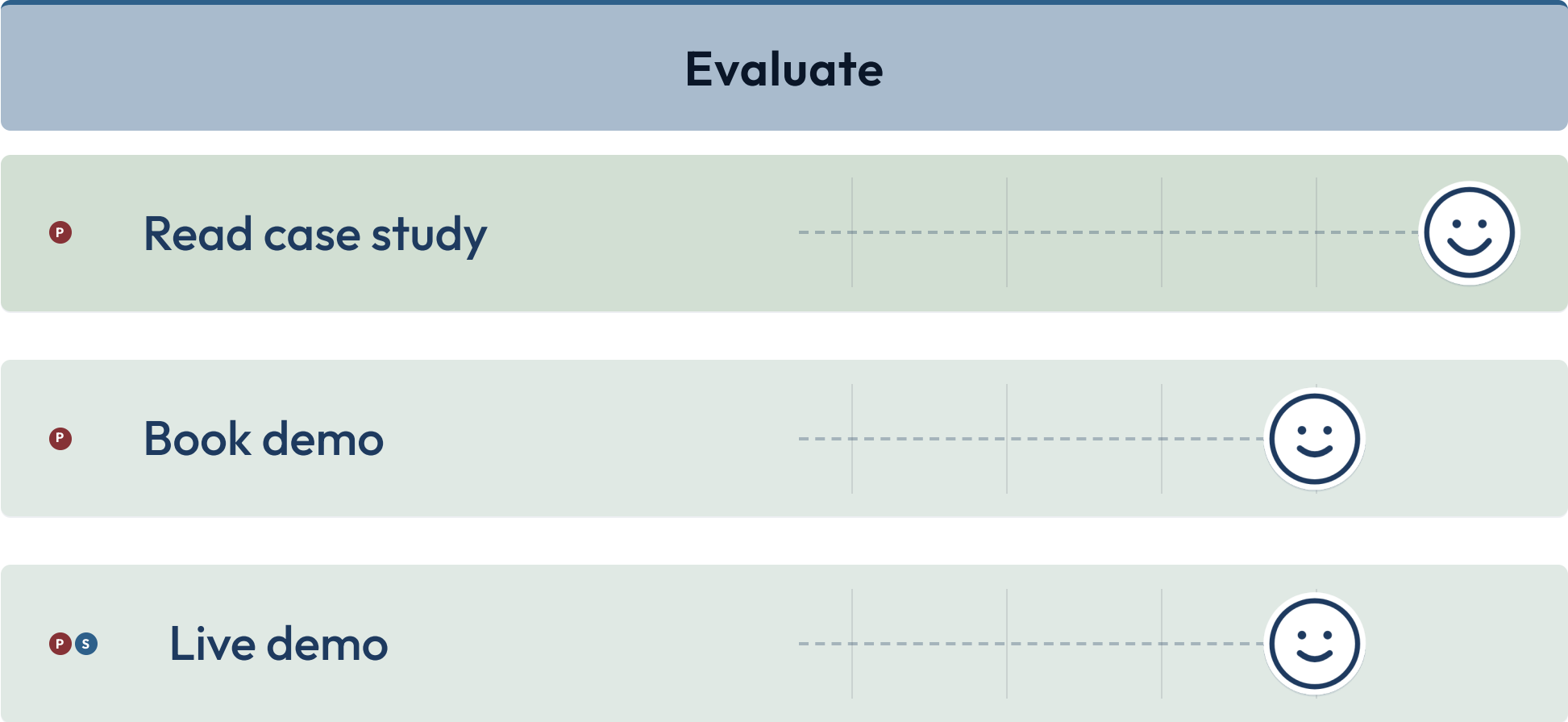
Plotted face — seated on a pain-to-delight track with a dashed reach to the spine. The exact value, when you look closer.

A :1 task is then unmistakable →

Mood, twice over. (cont.)

A `:1` task is then unmistakable:
a pink row with the face pulled
to the edge.

Customer onboarding · trial to activation.



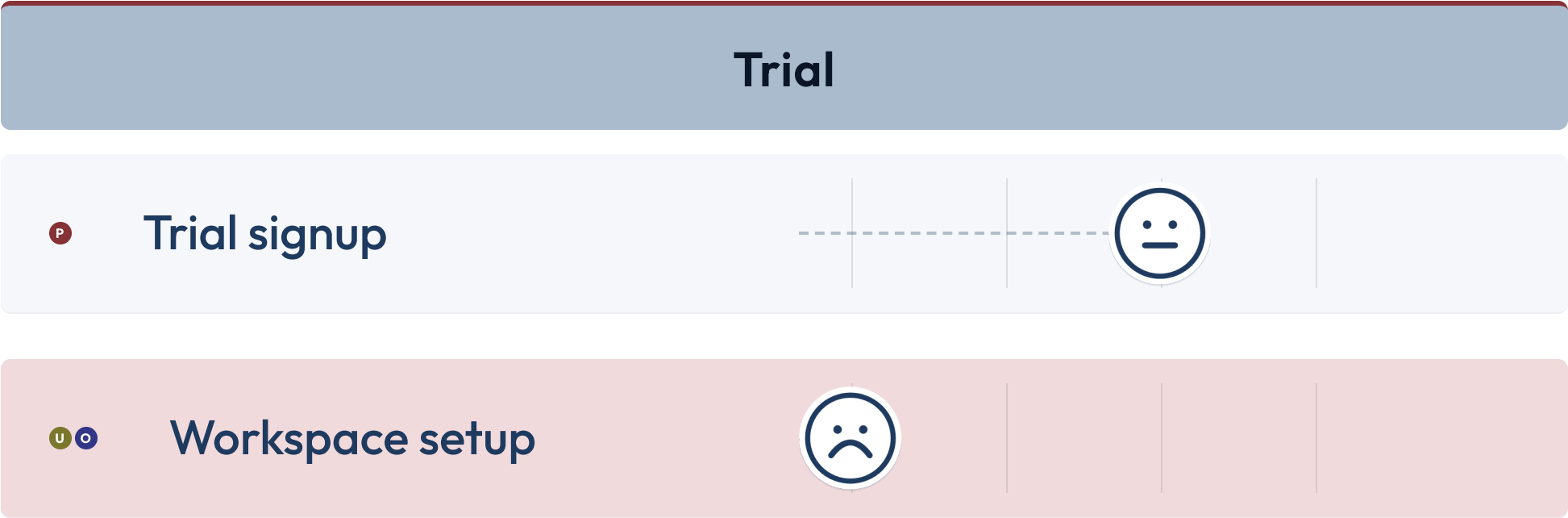
P prospect S sales U user

O onboarding

PAIN 1 2 3 4 5 DELIGHT

Trial →

Customer onboarding · trial to activation. (cont.)



P prospect S sales U user

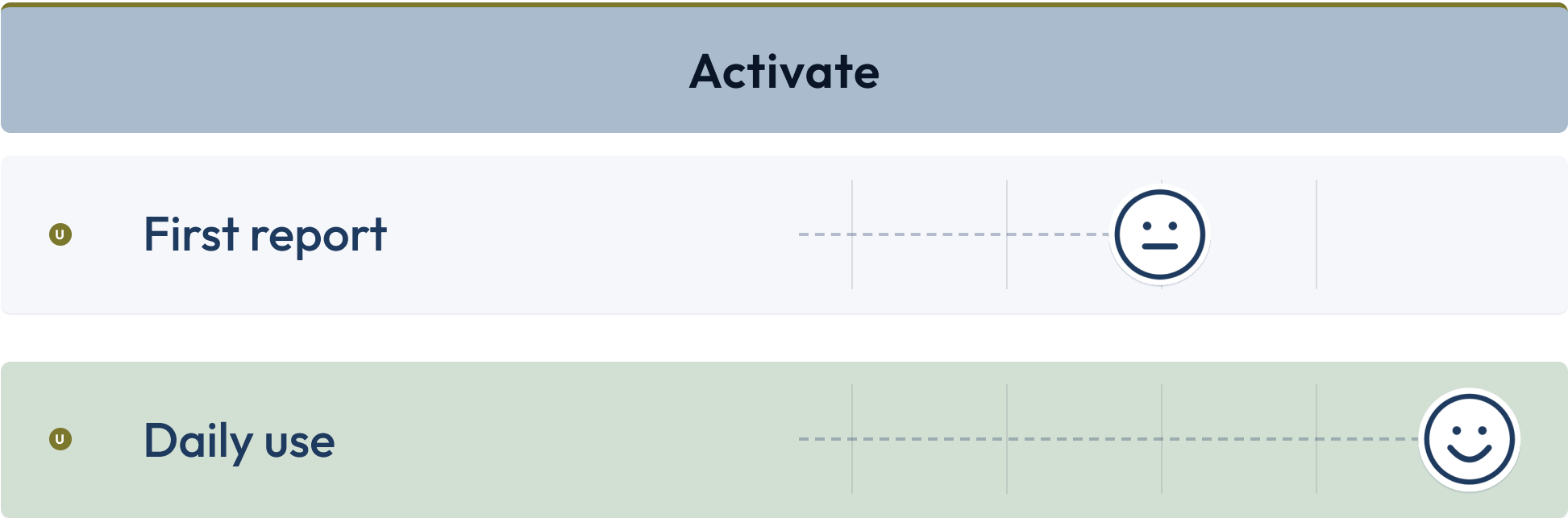
U onboarding

PAIN 1 2 3 4 5 DELIGHT

Activate →

Customer onboarding · trial to activation.

(cont.)

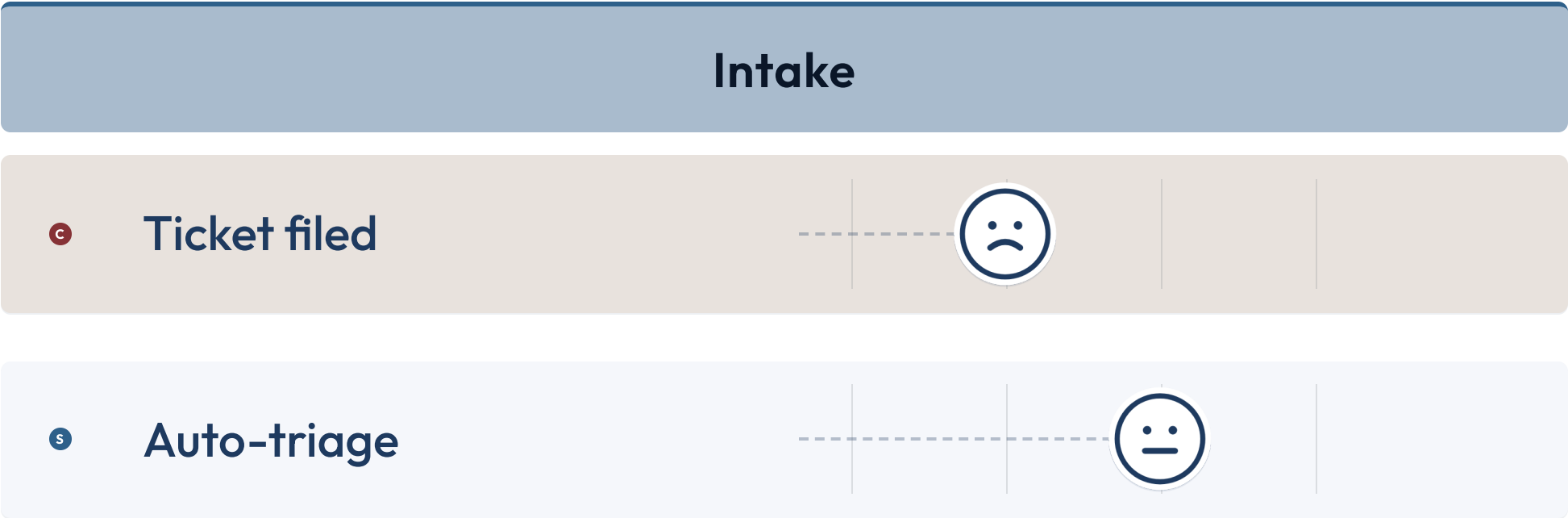


P prospect S sales U user

O onboarding

PAIN 1 2 3 4 5 DELIGHT

Support ticket · first touch to resolved.



C customer S system A agent E eng

PAIN 1 2 3 4 5 DELIGHT

Work →

Support ticket · first touch to resolved.

(cont.)



C customer S system A agent E eng

PAIN 1 2 3 4 5 DELIGHT

Close →

Support ticket • first touch to resolved. (cont.)

Close



Confirmation



C

customer

S

s system

A

A agent

E

E eng

PAIN

1

2

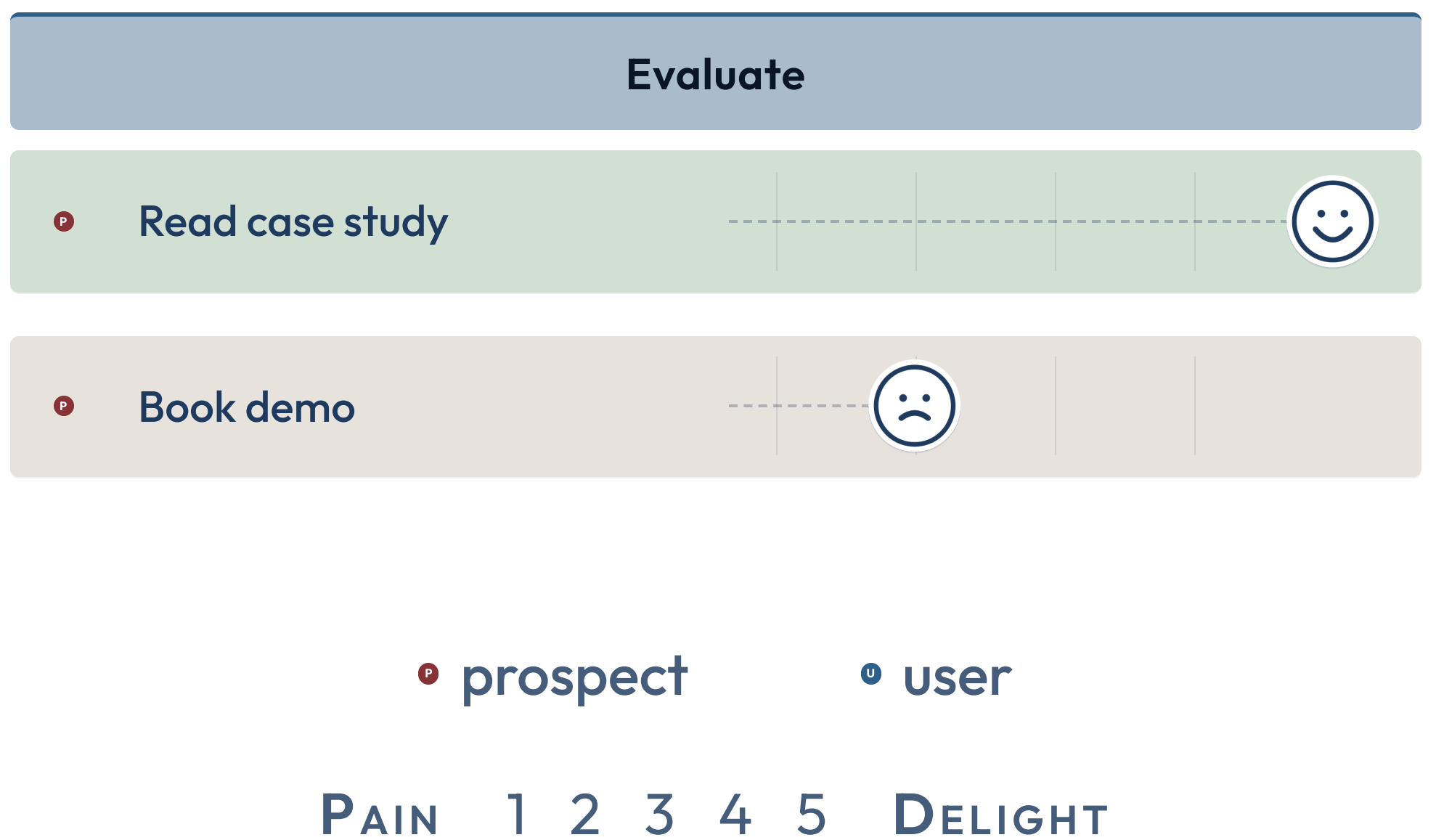
3

4

5

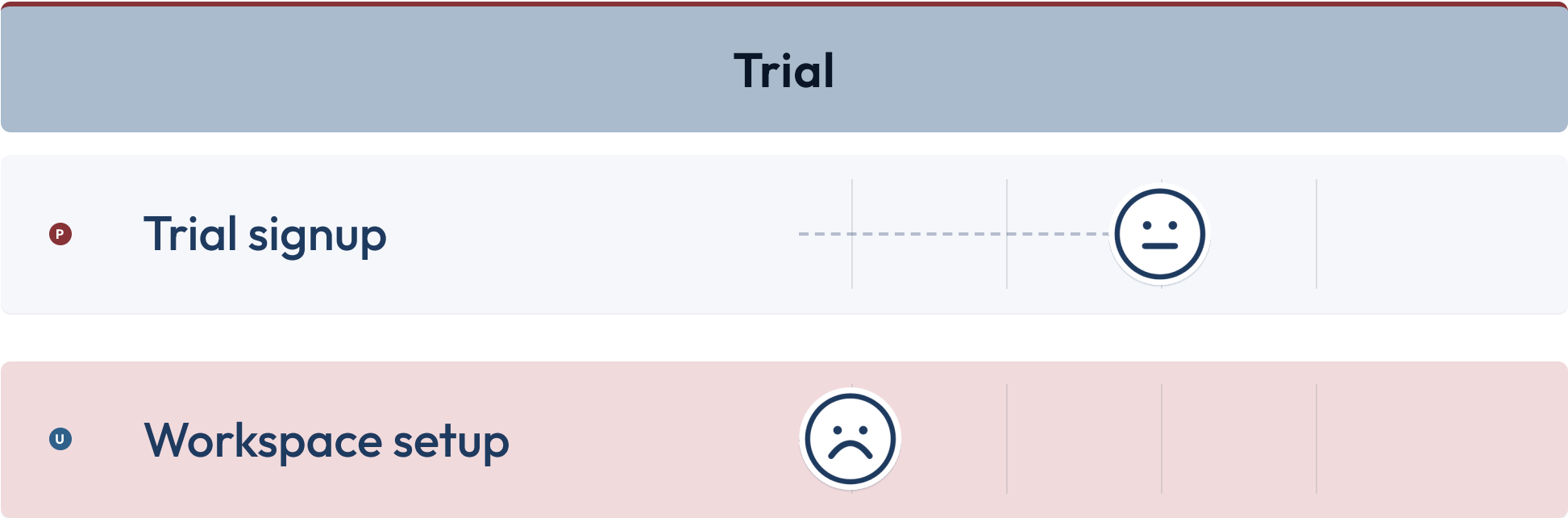
DELIGHT

Heatmap · where the trial drops off.



Trial →

Heatmap · where the trial drops off. (cont.)

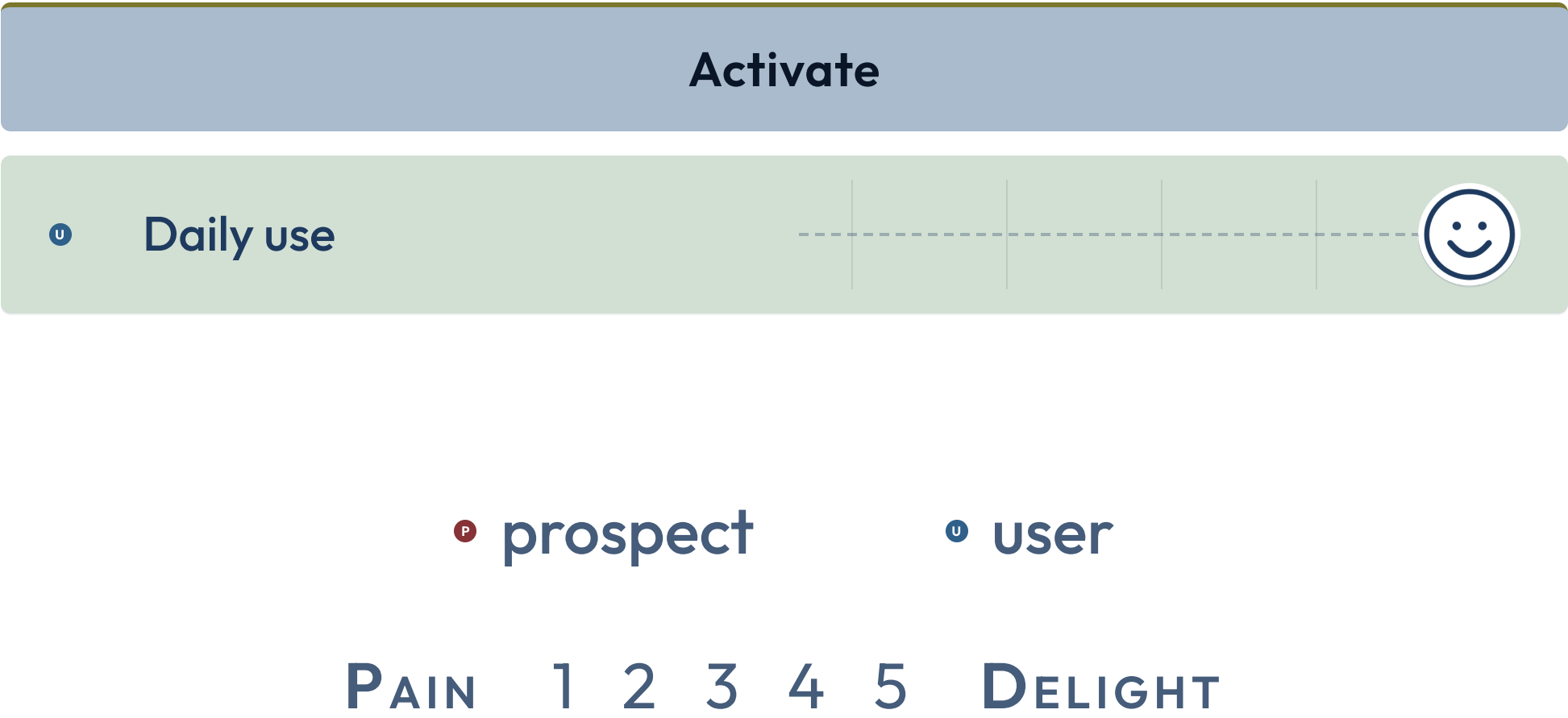


P prospect U user

PAIN 1 2 3 4 5 DELIGHT

Activate →

Heatmap · where the trial drops off. (cont.)



A portrait deck is a different box, not a smaller slide.

The win isn't shrinking the journey to fit — it's giving the vertical canvas its own composition, where the emotional arc runs down the page and the worst moment is the one your eye lands on first.